

RHEA SHARMA

SENIOR DATA SCIENTIST

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Scientist with 9+ years of experience applying statistics, mathematics, data mining, machine learning, pattern recognition, and predictive modeling to product and business problems. Experienced in discovering and integrating new data sources, designing analytical experiments, working with large structured and unstructured datasets, and deploying analytical models with software developers and machine-learning engineers. Strong record of translating complex findings into clear recommendations for product, engineering, leadership, and client stakeholders.

CORE SKILLS

Data Science & Statistics: Statistical analysis, hypothesis testing, regression, probability, experimental design, A/B testing, pattern recognition, predictive modeling, time-series analysis, clustering, anomaly detection, feature engineering

Programming & Data: Python, SQL, pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, XGBoost, Spark, data mining, ETL, data validation, structured and unstructured data

Analytics & Visualization: Tableau, Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, matplotlib, business analytics, KPI design, stakeholder reporting

Production & Collaboration: Model evaluation, error analysis, ML pipelines, model deployment, Git, REST APIs, cross-functional product/engineering collaboration, project planning and delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Scientist | Northstar Analytics Pvt. Ltd. | Bengaluru May 2021 - Present

- Lead data strategy for three product domains, identifying and integrating new internal, partner, and third-party datasets that expanded analytical coverage and improved product decision-making.
- Partner with product design, engineering, software development, and machine-learning engineering teams to translate business needs into data products, analytical models, and production-ready workflows.
- Research and develop statistical and machine-learning models for classification, forecasting, propensity scoring, anomaly detection, and customer-behavior analysis; improved model F1 scores by 12-18% across multiple use cases.
- Design and execute analytical experiments and A/B tests to solve pricing, retention, conversion, and product-adoption problems across concurrent client and product initiatives.
- Identify, collect, clean, validate, and analyze large structured and unstructured datasets from transaction systems, application logs, surveys, customer interactions, and external sources.
- Build and evaluate algorithms for high-volume data stores using Python, SQL, Spark, scikit-learn, and XGBoost; perform error analysis, feature refinement, and data-quality checks to improve accuracy and consistency.
- Analyze trends, patterns, and drivers with clear business objectives; present findings through Tableau dashboards, Excel analyses, and PowerPoint presentations to technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- Coordinate delivery plans, risks, milestones, and stakeholder reviews for multiple analytics initiatives, providing more than three years of hands-on project leadership and mentoring four analysts/data scientists.
- Track current developments in machine learning, experimentation, responsible AI, and industry analytics practices and evaluate relevant techniques for adoption.

Data Scientist | Vertex Retail Intelligence Pvt. Ltd. | Pune July 2017 - April 2021

- Developed predictive models for demand forecasting, customer segmentation, churn risk, and campaign response using Python, SQL, statistical methods, and machine-learning algorithms.
- Performed exploratory data analysis, data mining, missing-value treatment, outlier analysis, feature engineering, and validation to improve uniformity and accuracy of analytical datasets.
- Combined sales, customer, web-behavior, product, and text-based feedback data to uncover trends and hidden opportunities for merchandising and marketing teams.
- Created Tableau dashboards and recurring Excel/PowerPoint reporting packs that converted analytical findings into business actions for senior stakeholders and client teams.
- Worked in a research-oriented analytics group supporting several concurrent projects and collaborated with engineers to operationalize scoring pipelines and monitor model performance.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- Customer Churn Prediction: Built and validated gradient-boosting and logistic-regression models using 2.4M customer records; improved high-risk customer identification and supported retention targeting.
- Demand Forecasting Platform: Developed time-series and ensemble forecasting models and worked with engineers to productionize batch scoring, monitoring, and exception reporting.
- Voice-of-Customer Mining: Analyzed unstructured customer comments using text preprocessing, clustering, and sentiment features to identify recurring service and product themes.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) in Statistics | Savitribai Phule Pune University | 2017

CERTIFICATION

Certified Analytics Professional (CAP) | 2024